Aleksandr Detushev

Lead Game Designer

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Project: Warspear Online ↗ · Google Play ↗ · App Store ↗

Profile

Lead Game Designer with 6+ years on Warspear Online, a live 2D MMORPG with 5M+ downloads, a 20-class roster, and deep progression systems. Focused on class design, long-term balance, endgame content, talent and guild systems, and live economy-aware design in a game where players invest heavily over time.

Currently leading a team of 3 designers while staying hands-on with system design, encounter design, and feature direction. Most of my work focuses on building systems that connect — where class design drives economy, progression feeds daily engagement, and balance changes account for player trust.

Work Experience

Lead Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online

2022 – Present

- Lead a team of 3 game designers and coordinate their work across live updates, feature ownership, and cross-team delivery.
- Coordinate design direction across engineering, art, UI/UX, and product, translating feature goals into implementation-ready plans.
- Own class balance across a 20-class roster, competitive guild raids, the talent system, non-combat guild progression, and seasonal content delivery.
- Define feature scope and priorities from concept to release, balancing design ambition with live production constraints.
- Improve internal design workflows through structured reviews, clearer documentation standards, and cross-team handoffs.
- Ship balance updates in a monetized progression game where class changes directly affect player investment and require careful trust management.
- Stay hands-on with systems design, encounter design, gameplay logic, and design documentation alongside leadership responsibilities.

Senior Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online
2019 – 2022

- Designed and balanced 4 new playable classes for a 20-class live MMORPG roster.
- Delivered Templar and Chieftain in 2020, then Beastmaster and Reaper in 2022, shaping class identity, skill kits, gameplay roles, and long-term live balance considerations.
- Designed each class to fill a specific gap: Templar added faction-level control, Chieftain drove demand for a new weapon path, Beastmaster gave new players a forgiving entry point, and Reaper introduced transformation-based gameplay with custom UI needs.
- Created new itemization demand through class-specific gear paths (dual magical maces, two-handed spears) without devaluing existing player progression.
- Led large-scale class rebalances, favoring alternative buffs and gameplay-loop changes over direct nerfs to preserve player trust.
- Tracked community sentiment, class activity trends, and monetization signals to guide balance decisions and time meta shifts.
- Rebuilt the Talent system from a shallow passive layer into a long-term progression pillar with per-class trees, multi-source daily caps, and talents that modify skill behavior rather than just stats.

Game Designer

Aigrind — Warspear Online
2017 – 2019

- Designed seasonal events and dungeons for a live MMORPG with a regular update cadence.
- Reworked dungeon structure and encounter pacing to reduce repetition across yearly content cycles and keep repeatable content feeling fresh over time.
- Prepared implementation-ready design documentation and collaborated closely with programmers and artists to ship content under tight live deadlines.

Selected Systems

Talent System
Rebuilt the talent system into a core progression pillar. Per-class and per-guild trees with daily-capped multi-source progression. Talents modify skill behavior and create real build diversity. Build switching is supported but acts as a controlled resource sink.

Competitive Guild Content
Co-designed the competitive guild raid system and owned all encounter design. Seasonal raid showdowns with up to 15 difficulty tiers, leaderboard-driven competition, and staged mechanic escalation. Strong economy sink through consumable and preparation item demand.

Class Ecosystem & Live Balance
Managed live balance across 20 classes in a game with deep player investment. Strengthened alternatives over direct nerfs, used gameplay-loop adjustments alongside stat changes, and tracked

Live Content Design
Designed and iterated on seasonal events, dungeons, and repeatable features across a regular live update cadence with ongoing post-release support and tuning.

community sentiment, class activity, and monetization signals to guide decisions.

Catacombs
Designed a session-based PvPvE extraction mode. Players earn loot through PvE objectives but risk losing it on death. Rewards are secured only through successful extraction before a timer expires. Includes lobby registration, group-based hostility, and a dedicated reward storage system.

Non-Combat Guilds
Designed three daily progression systems (Adventurers, Assassins, Mages), each with a unique gameplay loop and gated access through guild talent trees. Guild talents extend buildcrafting with class-specific effects, creating a second progression layer beyond core class talents.

Skills & Tools

- Class ecosystem design and balance in a 20-class live MMORPG
- Long-term progression and build diversity systems
- Guild, social, and repeatable engagement features
- PvE and PvP systems design for live content
- Player-trust-aware monetisation thinking
- Cross-functional leadership in live production

Tools

- Confluence
- Google Sheets
- Figma
- Redmine
- MySQL Workbench
- TortoiseSVN
- Unity (hobby / prototyping)

Languages

- Russian — Native
- English — Professional working proficiency

Education

Saint Petersburg State University of Aerospace Instrumentation (SUAI)

Computer Science (unfinished degree)